Shabnam Rahimfallah

Ph.D. Student in Economics, Purdue University
West Lafayette, IN, USA srahimfa@purdue.edu LinkedIn

Education

Purdue University West Lafayette, IN, USA
Ph.D. in Economics *Expected May 2028*
Field: Experimental and Behavioral Economics

University of Tehran Tehran, Iran
M.Sc. in Economics *January 2022*

University of Science and Culture Tehran, Iran
B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering *July 2015*

Research Interest

Research Areas: Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics, Reinforcement Learning, Game Theory, Computational Economics

Working Papers

Rational Inattention and Cooperation
I study how cognitive load affects cooperation in the indefinitely repeated Prisoner's Dilemma. I combine simulations of rationally inattentive Q-learning agents with a laboratory experiment that varies cognitive load. Cognitive load reduces cooperation because it pushes people away from complex strategies that depend on past play.
Presented at: Purdue University, 2026

Works in Progress

Money under Cognitive Load *Ongoing Research*
A lab experiment testing whether monetary exchange offsets the drop in cooperation caused by cognitive load in a repeated helping game.

Cognitive Load and Strategic Choice in One-Shot Games *Ongoing Research*
A lab experiment testing whether high cognitive load reduces reasoning depth, makes people treat similar games alike, or makes their choices less precise.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

November 2026 Krannert Doctoral Student Association (KDSA), Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN, USA

October 2026 North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA), Charlottesville, VA, USA

Teaching Experience

Purdue University West Lafayette, IN, USA

- **ECON 21000: Principles of Economics (Undergraduate)** *Spring 2027 (Upcoming)*
- **ECON 21000: Principles of Economics (Undergraduate)** *Spring 2026*

Purdue University West Lafayette, IN, USA

- **ECON 57600: Statistical & Machine Learning (Graduate)** *Fall 2026*
- **ECON 67100: Econometrics I (Ph.D.)** *Fall 2026*
- **ECON 56200: Econometrics I (Graduate)** *Spring 2026*
- **ECON 25100: Microeconomics (Undergraduate)** *Spring 2026*
- **ECON 52100: Consumer and Producer Theory (Graduate)** *Fall 2025*

- **ECON 46100: Industrial Organization (Undergraduate)** *Spring 2025*

University of Tehran *2020 – 2021*

- **Behavioral Economics (Graduate)**
- **Microeconomics (Graduate)**
- **Advanced Macroeconomics II (Graduate)**

Committee

- **Professor Yaroslav Rosokha (Chair)**
  Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Purdue University
  yrosokha@purdue.edu
- **Professor Tim Cason**
  Distinguished Professor, Department of Economics, Purdue University
  cason@purdue.edu
- **Professor David Gill**
  James Brooke Henderson Professor, Department of Economics, Purdue University
  gill53@purdue.edu